

PGD WITHDRAWN

Melatonin for Primary Insomnia · Circadin 2mg PR, and unlicensed melatonin tablets

This Patient Group Direction has been withdrawn and must not be used.

Reason: both arms, on legal grounds

The unlicensed arm. Its medicine box reads 'Melatonin 1mg, 3mg, 5mg tablets (unlicensed preparations)'. The Human Medicines Regulations 2012 do not permit an unlicensed medicine to be supplied under a Patient Group Direction. That arm has never had a lawful basis and cannot be corrected by amendment; it needs a licensed product.

The Circadin arm. It states the medicine is 'indicated for short-term management of insomnia in patients aged 18 years and over'. Circadin is licensed for patients aged 55 or over. Off-label supply under a PGD is permitted where it is clearly stated and justified. This arm asserts a licence it does not have, so patients aged 18 to 54 were supplied off-label without being told and without a recorded justification.

What to do now

Do not supply melatonin under this PGD. Refer to the patient's GP. Patients already supplied should be advised to complete or stop their course in the usual way; there is no safety concern with the medicine itself, and no action is needed on clinical grounds.

Also being addressed in the rewrite

Suspected sleep apnoea, depression, shift work, parasomnia and narcolepsy are listed as referral red flags in the summary pages but appear in neither arm's exclusion criteria.

There is no cap on repeat supply and no referral trigger in either arm.

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